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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

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18 must-know stories, 24 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 860 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Preventive Detention in India – Article 22 and Constitutional Safeguards

The Supreme Court issued October 11, 2026, directions concerning alleged illegal detentions and movement restrictions during Delhi protests. Preventive detention detains a person without criminal trial or conviction to prevent anticipated offences or threats to public order. The National Security Act, 1980, permits preventive detention for reasons prejudicial to India's defense, foreign relations, or state security. Section 163 of BNSS, 2023, empowers Executive Magistrates to issue urgent prohibitory orders to avert danger, riots, or disturbances. Article 22(4) mandates that a person cannot be detained beyond three months without Advisory Board review, with limited exceptions. Article 22(5) requires detaining authorities to communicate detention grounds promptly and allow representation against the order. Judicial pronouncements such as State of Telangana (2022) emphasize that preventive detention is exceptional and must not be routine. Reform priorities stress strict necessity, procedural compliance, judicial oversight, proportionality, and the protection of peaceful protests.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** National Security Act was enacted in the year 1980.; Section 163 of the BNSS, 2023, replaced Section 144 of the CrPC, 1973.; Article 22(4) generally limits preventive detention without Advisory Board review to three months.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the delicate balance between state security imperatives and individual fundamental freedoms under Articles 14, 19, and 21.; Reinforces the judiciary's role in checking arbitrary executive action and ensuring procedural compliance in detentions.*

Static — Article 22 of the Constitution provides protection against arrest and detention in certain cases, including specific procedural safeguards for preventive detention. The National Security Act (NSA) of 1980 grants central and state governments powers to detain individuals to prevent acts prejudicial to national security. Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023, replaces former Section 144 CrPC to issue urgent orders regulating movement or assembly.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

SC/ST Status Doesn't Travel Across States Even When Caste Is Notified In Both States Of Origin &...

The judgment was reported by Verdictum concerning the legal status of SC/ST reservations across state borders. The Supreme Court held that Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe status does not travel across states, even when the caste is notified in both states.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court · **Prelims:** The ruling concerns the interstate transferability of SC/ST status.; Reservation benefits are tied to state-specific notifications under constitutional provisions.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the territorial limits of constitutional reservations for marginalized communities.; Ensures consistency with the federal framework regarding state-specific identification of Scheduled Castes and Tribes.*

Static — Articles 341 and 342 of the Constitution empower the President to specify castes and tribes for each State and Union Territory. A caste notified as Scheduled Caste in one state may not necessarily be notified as such in another state. Benefits of reservation for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes are generally restricted to the state of origin where they are notified.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare, Society · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

Verdictum: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court likely to hear Rahul Gandhi, other Oppn. leaders' plea against ECI decisions over SIR

Rahul Gandhi and 10 other INDIA bloc leaders filed a petition in the Supreme Court against alleged electoral irregularities and ECI's functioning. The petition faced a delay as the Supreme Court registry flagged 14 defects, including a Rs 220 court fee shortfall and missing vakalatnamas. The legal team requested the matter be listed on Wednesday after curing the defects. The petition seeks an independent time-bound inquiry into decisions taken unilaterally by Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. It also demands the suspension of the ongoing special intensive revision of electoral rolls pending the inquiry. The plea references an Indian Express report indicating two election commissioners objected to unilateral decision-making on 14 occasions. Respondents named in the petition include the ECI, Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, and election commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi. The petitioners stated they aim to protect the constitutional guarantee of universal adult suffrage and ensure free and fair elections.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Rahul Gandhi, Gyanesh Kumar, Mallikarjun Kharge, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu, Vivek Joshi · **Prelims:** The petition was filed by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and 10 other INDIA bloc leaders.; The Supreme Court registry flagged 14 defects, including a Rs 220 court fee shortfall.; The Chief Election Commissioner named in the petition is Gyanesh Kumar.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It raises important constitutional questions regarding the collective functioning and powers of election commissioners under Article 324.; It highlights tensions between opposition political parties and election authorities over electoral roll revision exercises.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional authority responsible for administering union and state election processes in India. Article 324 of the Constitution of India vests the superintendence, direction, and control of elections in the Election Commission. The Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners are appointed by the President under the provisions of the 2023 Act governing their service conditions.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Ethics & Integrity · Prelims angle: Judgment

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on hindustantimes.com*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Government mobilizes National Law Universities to target Criminal Case Backlogs across 100 Hotspot Districts

The government convened a virtual meeting with Vice Chancellors of National Law Universities to deploy academic resources in tackling the country's severe case pendency. The Ministry of Law and Justice has initiated a research-based mission involving 19 National Law Universities to target high litigation pendency across 100 hotspot judicial districts. In a significant move to address the issue of pendency of cases at the District and Subordinate Judiciary, the Ministry of Law and Justice, Government of India, has decided to take action in a focused manner by identifying hotspot districts where such cases are in large number. Over 5.8 crore cases are pending across courts in the country, of which the majority are in district and subordinate courts. Further, those identified 100 districts account for over half of all district-co

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Shri Arjun Ram Meghwal, Ministry of Law and Justice, National Law Universities, BPR&D, NCRB · **Prelims:** Over 5.8 crore cases are pending across courts in the country.; The top 100 identified districts account for over half of all district-court pendency.; Nineteen National Law Universities from sixteen states participated in the initiative.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Leverages academic expertise and student manpower from NLUs for grassroots legal research.; Targets the top 100 districts which account for over half of total district-court pendency.*

Static — National Law Universities (NLUs) are premier legal education institutions in India established under state legislative enactments to elevate the standard of legal education and research. The Ministry of Law and Justice oversees the administration of justice in India, managing the legislative framework for the Supreme Court, High Courts, and subordinate judiciary. Case pendency and backlog in Indian courts are long-standing systemic issues caused by judge shortages, frequent adjournments, and procedural delays.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy

PIB: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

SC quashes UP police notice asking social media data of journalist who reported Ayodhya temple theft

The Supreme Court set aside a UP police directive seeking digital footprints of journalist Abhishek Upadhyay from June onwards. The Ghaziabad police had issued a notice to social media platform X on August 22 to trace the journalist after an FIR. An FIR for an alleged road rage case and caste slur was registered against Upadhyay on August 18 near Shipra Mall. The bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi termed the notice an overkill, questioning the relevance of past data. The court ruled that post-FIR information cannot be sought unless proven proportional and alternate investigative measures are inadequate. The Supreme Court ordered that any information collected prior to August 22 shall not be used against the petitioner. The court directed the police to release Upadhyay's vehicle within two days and extended protection from arrest. The court noted the need for guidelines to protect citizen privacy and prevent roving and fishing inquiries during investigations.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh · **Who:** Supreme Court, CJI Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi, Abhishek Upadhyay · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court bench was headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi.; The police notice to social media intermediary X was issued on August 22, 2026.; The alleged road rage incident took place on August 18 near Shipra Mall in Ghaziabad.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces the constitutional right to privacy against overbroad state surveillance and fishing inquiries.; Highlights the delicate balance between legitimate law enforcement powers and the protection of press freedom.*

Static — The Supreme Court of India is the highest judicial court under the Constitution, established under Article 124 as the federal court and guardian of the Constitution. The Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, regulate digital media and intermediaries, outlining protocols for law enforcement agencies requesting user data. The Fundamental Right to Privacy is protected under Article 21 of the Indian Constitution, established as an intrinsic part of the right to life and personal liberty by a landmark nine-judge bench in 2017.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Society, History, Art & Culture · Prelims angle: Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

BIMSTEC adopts Delhi Declaration to fight cross-border terror and crime

BIMSTEC countries adopted the Delhi Declaration at the First BIMSTEC Home Ministers' Meeting, focusing on regional peace and security. The member nations reaffirmed their commitment to combatting cross-border terrorism, terror financing, radicalisation, and transnational crimes. The grouping condemned all forms of terrorism and called for implementing UN Security Council sanctions, including the 1267 Committee measures. Security cooperation will rest on principles like sovereign equality, territorial integrity, non-interference, and mutual respect. The declaration prioritised information sharing, mutual legal assistance, extradition, and capacity building among member states. Ministers approved the Convention against Trafficking in Persons and the BIMSTEC Plan of Action on Drug Control. They also approved an MoU on capacity building against money laundering and terror financing, plus an action plan on illicit financial flows. A plan to improve natural disaster preparedness through regional risk planning and joint exercises was also approved. India's leadership in regional security was appreciated, with India committing to share expertise in police training and counter-terrorism.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** Delhi, India · **Who:** BIMSTEC Home Ministers · **Prelims:** First BIMSTEC Home Ministers' Meeting adopted the Delhi Declaration.; BIMSTEC comprises seven member countries: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand.; Proposed BIMSTEC Centre for Disaster Management is located in Jamnagar, Gujarat.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens regional security architecture and counter-terrorism coordination in India's immediate neighbourhood.; Facilitates concrete legal frameworks like the Convention against Trafficking in Persons and anti-money laundering mechanisms.*

Static — BIMSTEC stands for the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation, established in June 1997 through the Bangkok Declaration. It comprises seven member states: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand, connecting South Asia and Southeast Asia. The grouping aims to promote rapid economic growth, social progress, and active collaboration on matters of common interest in the Bay of Bengal region.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Internal Security

indiatoday.in: read the source · also reported by All India Radio (NewsOnAir)

GS2 MAKE NOTES

LAC must be stable for normalisation of ties with China: EAM S Jaishankar

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar stated that the Line of Actual Control must remain stable for normalising India-China relations. He asserted that any disturbance along the border will have consequences, noting how the 2020 Galwan Valley clashes severely strained bilateral ties. The minister pointed out that the border situation has settled down to a great extent since 2024 following confidence-building measures. He clarified that India does not insist on a full boundary resolution to do business, but maintains that the bar requires preserving peace and tranquillity. Jaishankar highlighted major economic concerns, stating that the trade balance is heavily tilted towards China and Indian sectors lack a level playing field. He mentioned that the military standoff in eastern Ladakh, which lasted for over four and a half years, finally ended in late 2024. The minister recalled that between 1975 and 2020, no blood was shed on the border, representing a long period of peaceful coexistence. Business and market access policies will be dealt with separately from the boundary question, while prioritizing border stability.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** S Jaishankar · **Prelims:** The Galwan Valley clashes resulting in military fatalities occurred in 2020.; The military standoff in eastern Ladakh lasted for over four and a half years before ending in late 2024.; The last fatalities on the India-China border prior to 2020 occurred in 1975.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Outlines India's clear diplomatic precondition that border peace must precede overall normalisation of ties with China.; Highlights ongoing economic asymmetries, including trade deficits and market access barriers faced by Indian sectors in China.*

Static — The Line of Actual Control is the demarcation line that separates Indian-controlled territory from Chinese-controlled territory in the Sino-Indian border dispute. India and China share a nearly 3,488-kilometer long border divided into Western, Middle, and Eastern sectors, largely lacking a mutually agreed demarcation. The 2020 Galwan Valley clash resulted in the first military fatalities on the India-China border since 1975, severely deteriorating bilateral diplomatic ties.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

NDTV: read the source · free copy on theprint.in · also reported by All India Radio (NewsOnAir), Times of India

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Canada aims to seal India trade pact by year-end amid push to diversify ties

Canada aims to conclude a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with India by the end of the year as part of a trade diversification strategy. The push to diversify trade and reduce reliance on the US is driven by President Donald Trump's protectionist trade policies. Canadian Foreign Minister Anita Anand stated that the goal is to double non-US trade over the next ten years to ensure national resilience and sovereignty. Indian trade negotiators visited Canada recently, and Canadian Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu visited India with a business delegation to advance talks. Prime Minister Mark Carney and Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi discussed the agreement, and Modi is expected to visit Canada in December. Canada projects the deal could more than double bilateral goods and services trade to $70 billion annually by 2030 from $30.4 billion in 2025. Recent cooperation includes a C$2.6 billion uranium supply agreement between Cameco and India, alongside Fairfax Financial Holdings buying a majority stake in IDBI Bank. Both nations are working to rebuild diplomatic ties following a 2023 dispute over the killing of Sikh separatist Hardeep Singh Nijjar in Canada.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** New Delhi, India; Canada · **Who:** Anita Anand, Mark Carney, Narendra Modi, Maninder Sidhu · **Prelims:** Canada aims to conclude the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with India by the end of the year.; Bilateral goods and services trade stood at $30.4 billion in 2025 and is projected to reach $70 billion by 2030.; Cameco signed a C$2.6 billion uranium supply agreement with India earlier in the year.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Offers significant export and investment opportunities for both Indian and Canadian businesses across multiple sectors.; Helps Canada reduce economic reliance on the United States and enhances bilateral supply chain resilience.*

Static — A Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) is a free trade pact between two nations that covers negotiation of trade in services, investment, and economic cooperation. Trade diversification strategies help nations mitigate supply chain vulnerabilities and protect domestic economies from sudden geopolitical shifts or protectionist measures. Bilateral trade pacts typically aim to reduce tariff barriers, streamline customs procedures, and enhance market access for both goods and services.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by Times of India

Social Justice & Welfare

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet clears Rs 53,428 crore for social assistance scheme, revises disability pension norms

The Union Cabinet approved extending the National Social Assistance Programme for five years from 2026-27 to 2030-31 with a total cost of Rs 53,428 crore. The program is renamed Pradhan Mantri Samajik Sahayata Yojana, along with new names for all its associated pension and family benefit sub-schemes. About 3.20 crore people across all 36 states and Union Territories will benefit from the extended and revised social assistance measures. Under the new disability pension rules, beneficiaries aged under 79 will receive Rs 375 per month, and those aged 80 or older will get Rs 625. The disability requirement is lowered from 80 percent to 40 percent, and the minimum age requirement is removed so people can qualify from birth. Existing pension programs for older adults and widows, as well as the family benefit scheme, will continue without changes to their assistance amounts. The Cabinet also approved a Productivity Linked Bonus equivalent to 78 days wages worth Rs 2,009.61 crore for 11,40,770 non-gazetted railway employees. Details about updated eligibility rules and new assistance rates for the disability pension scheme will be implemented within three months.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** Total outlay approved for the scheme: Rs 53,428 crore.; Duration of extension: 2026-27 to 2030-31.; Revised disability requirement percentage: 40 percent (lowered from 80 percent).

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands social safety net coverage by lowering the disability threshold from 80 percent to 40 percent and removing minimum age caps.; Rebrands central welfare schemes under unified nomenclature while committing substantial budgetary outlays through 2031.*

Static — The National Social Assistance Programme was originally introduced on August 15, 1995, to provide social assistance to poor households. The program draws its constitutional backing from Article 41 of the Indian Constitution, directing the state to secure public assistance for citizens in old age, unemployment, sickness, and disablement. It operates as a centrally sponsored or central sector welfare initiative aimed at fulfilling the Directive Principles of State Policy.

Syllabus: GS2: Social Justice & Welfare, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Scheme

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on zeebiz.com · also reported by All India Radio (NewsOnAir), Business Standard, PIB, Times of India, BusinessLine

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Pakistan Ranks Lowest in Global Hunger Index 2026

The Global Hunger Index 2026 report was recently released, revealing India's current rank and nutritional status. India is ranked 100th in the Global Hunger Index 2026, placing it in the 'serious' category of hunger with the worst child-wasting level in South Asia.

When: 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Global Hunger Index publishers Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe · **Prelims:** India's rank in Global Hunger Index 2026 is 100th.; India falls in the 'serious' category of the index.; India's child-wasting level is the worst in South Asia.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights critical gaps in India's child nutrition and public health delivery mechanisms.; Serves as a crucial input for policymakers to evaluate welfare schemes like Poshan Abhiyaan and NFSA.*

Static — The Global Hunger Index is jointly published by Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe. The index uses four indicators: undernourishment, child stunting, child wasting, and child mortality. Undernourishment measures the share of the population with insufficient caloric intake.

Syllabus: GS2: Social Justice & Welfare, International Relations · Prelims angle: Report/Index

Careers360: read the source

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Government Approves Strategic Restructuring of IDBI Bank Ltd.

The Union Cabinet approved the strategic stake sale and restructuring of IDBI Bank to Canada Inc., whose parent company is Fairfax Financial Holdings, for Rs 52,878 crore. Fairfax will acquire a 60.72% aggregate stake in IDBI Bank, comprising a 30.48% holding from the government and a 30.24% stake held by the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC). Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman described the transaction as a strategic restructuring, noting that the government and LIC will retain a combined 34% residual stake in the bank. Fairfax's winning bid was fixed at Rs 81 per share, which is higher than the revised benchmark price of Rs 75.99 per share determined using market-multiple and asset-valuation methods. Initial bids were previously rejected after failing to meet the original reserve price of Rs 94.42 per share, prompting a reassessment of the valuation by the government. Under the terms of the transaction, Fairfax must merge CSB Bank with IDBI Bank within two years and make an open offer for IDBI Bank shares under takeover rules.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, Fairfax Financial Holdings, Life Insurance Corporation (LIC), Reserve Bank of India (RBI) · **Prelims:** Fairfax Financial Holdings will acquire a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank.; The winning bid price is fixed at Rs 81 per share for a total transaction value of Rs 52,878 crore.; Fairfax is required to merge CSB Bank with IDBI Bank within two years.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Marks a major milestone in the government's long-pending plan to transfer management control of IDBI Bank.; Demonstrates the use of strategic restructuring and market-based valuation benchmarks to successfully conclude banking disinvestment.*

Static — IDBI Bank Ltd was established under the IDBI Act, 1964 as a financial institution providing credit and other facilities for the development of Indian industry. In 2004, IDBI was converted into a banking company, and it was categorized as a private sector bank by the Reserve Bank of India in 2019 after LIC acquired a controlling stake. The Prompt Corrective Action (PCA) framework is a tool used by the RBI to monitor banks that exhibit weaknesses in capital, asset quality, and profitability through regulatory trigger points.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, International Relations

PIB: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by NDTV, Economic Times

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India tightens Mauritius tax treaty rules to prevent misuse of tax benefits, effective August 10

India has tightened rules under its tax treaty with Mauritius to curb treaty shopping and prevent tax avoidance. The amended provisions came into force on August 10, 2026, following a notification by the Ministry of Finance. The changes stem from a protocol signed by India and Mauritius on March 7, 2024, amending their Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement. Tax benefits can now be denied if obtaining them was one of the principal purposes of an arrangement or transaction. The amendment revises the treaty preamble to eliminate double taxation without creating opportunities for tax evasion or avoidance. It targets treaty-shopping arrangements designed to obtain tax relief for the indirect benefit of third-jurisdiction residents. The protocol provisions will take effect in India under Section 159 of the Income-tax Act, 2025. The provisions apply from the date of entry into force, regardless of when taxes are levied or their taxable years.

When: August 10, 2026 · **Where:** India and Mauritius · **Who:** Ministry of Finance · **Prelims:** The protocol amending the India-Mauritius DTAA was signed on March 7, 2024.; The amended treaty provisions came into force on August 10, 2026.; The original India-Mauritius tax treaty was signed on August 24, 1982.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps prevent revenue loss and base erosion by stopping abusive tax avoidance practices.; Impacts foreign portfolio investors and private equity funds utilizing Mauritius as a routing hub.*

Static — A Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA) is a tax treaty signed between two or more countries to help taxpayers avoid paying double taxation on the same income. The Principal Purpose Test (PPT) is an anti-abuse rule under international tax norms that denies treaty benefits if obtaining them was a principal purpose of a transaction. Treaty shopping refers to a practice where a resident of a third country takes advantage of a tax treaty between two contracting countries.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU, Act/Bill/Rules

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on cnbctv18.com · also reported by cfo.economictimes.indiatimes.com, The New Indian Express, BusinessLine

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India to overtake Japan as 4th-largest economy in 2027 with $4.52 trillion GDP: IMF

India is projected to become the world's fourth-largest economy by 2027, overtaking Japan with a nominal GDP reaching $4.52 trillion. The IMF's regional economic outlook for Asia-Pacific laid out the contrasting trajectories of the two Asian nations. Japan will remain the fourth-largest economy this year, but is slated to slip to sixth place in 2027, falling behind India and the UK. The IMF raised India's 2026 growth forecast to 7.0 percent, citing strong fundamentals, fiscal prudence, and adequate reserves. India entered the current energy price shock caused by the US-Israel war on Iran from a strong macroeconomic position. Japan's growth is projected to slow to 0.7 percent in 2026 due to structural problems, an aging population, and an increase in energy prices. Japan has also faced a falling yen, surging inflation, and rising interest rates set by the Bank of Japan to their highest level in three decades. While Japan's economy benefits from AI investments, its regional neighbors have gained more, and Tokyo's Nikkei index recently fell due to tech stock plunges.

When: 2027 · **Where:** India, Japan · **Who:** International Monetary Fund (IMF), Krishna Srinivasan · **Prelims:** India's projected GDP in 2027 to become the 4th largest economy is $4.52 trillion.; The IMF raised India's 2026 growth forecast to 7.0 percent.; Japan's projected growth for 2026 is 0.7 percent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's rising stature and robust growth trajectory among major global economies.; Demonstrates the economic impact of structural challenges like aging populations and energy shocks on advanced economies like Japan.*

Static — The International Monetary Fund (IMF) is an international organization headquartered in Washington, D.C., working to foster global monetary cooperation and secure financial stability. Nominal Gross Domestic Product (GDP) measures the total market value of all finished goods and services produced in a country using current market prices. Japan's economic struggles stem largely from demographic shifts, specifically a rapidly aging population and a shrinking workforce leading to stagnant domestic demand.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Mint: read the source · free copy on newindianexpress.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

PROVISIONAL WHOLESALE PRICE INDEX, OUTPUT PRODUCER PRICE INDEX, AND TRIAL INPUT PRODUCER PRICE INDEX FOR THE MONTH OF SEPTEMBER 2026, AND FINAL INDEX FOR THE MONTH OF JULY 2026

The Ministry of Commerce and Industry released the provisional Wholesale Price Index (WPI) data for September 2026, showing an inflation rate of 11.39 per cent. Key highlights of WPI (Base Year 2022-23) for September 2026 All India Wholesale Price Index (WPI) inflation for September 2026 is 11.39 per cent on year-on-year (YoY) basis, compared to 9.92 per cent in August 2026. The index for All Commodities for September 2026 stands at 112.5, whereas it was 110.8 in August 2026. YoY inflation rates for major groups, namely, Primary Articles, Fuel and Power, and Manufactured Products are 8.67 per cent, 25.85 per cent, and 9.76 per cent, respectively in September 2026, compared to 7.76 per cent, 22.93 per cent, and 8.37 per cent, respectively in August 2026.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Commerce and Industry · **Prelims:** WPI inflation for September 2026 is 11.39 per cent.; The All Commodities index for September 2026 stands at 112.5.; Fuel and Power inflation for September 2026 is 25.85 per cent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *WPI serves as a crucial macro-economic indicator for tracking price pressures at the wholesale and producer level.; Changes in WPI components like Fuel and Power and Primary Articles help policymakers evaluate supply-side inflationary trends.*

Static — The Wholesale Price Index (WPI) measures the average change in prices of goods traded in the wholesale market. WPI in India is published by the Office of Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industry. The base year for the current WPI series is 2022-23, revised from the previous 2011-12 base year.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Data/Stats

PIB: read the source · also reported by BusinessLine, Economic Times, Business Standard

GS3 MAKE NOTES

BHAVYA: Creating Investment-Ready Manufacturing Ecosystems

The scheme was approved by the Cabinet in March 2026 and notified on 10 April 2026 to accelerate India's manufacturing sector. The Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna (BHAVYA) is a Rs. 33,660 crore central initiative launched to develop 100 plug-and-play industrial parks across India with state and private partnership. The parks will provide modern industrial infrastructure , reliable services, and faster approvals, reducing the time needed to set up new industries. The scheme aims to attract investment, support MSMEs, strengthen supply chains, create jobs, and drive industrial growth across regions. A New Phase in Manufacturing Policy India's manufacturing sector is undergoing structural change. It now contributes about 16–17 percent of GDP and employs over 27 million workers. The National Manufacturing Mission aims to raise this share to 25 percent by 2035.

When: March 2026 (Approved), 10 April 2026 (Notified), 2035 (Target year) · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, States, and Private Developers · **Prelims:** Total financial outlay of BHAVYA is Rs. 33,660 crore.; Target is to develop 100 plug-and-play industrial parks across India.; Manufacturing sector currently contributes about 16-17 percent of India's GDP and employs over 27 million workers.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Aims to raise the manufacturing sector's contribution to India's GDP to 25 percent by 2035 under the National Manufacturing Mission.; Reduces entry-level barriers, setup time, and capital costs for MSMEs and large manufacturing units alike.*

Static — Plug-and-play industrial infrastructure provides pre-built factory spaces, ready utilities, and common effluent treatment plants to eliminate greenfield project delays. Single-window clearance systems integrate multiple regulatory approvals from state and central departments onto a single digital portal to reduce compliance burdens. India's manufacturing policies have progressively evolved from localized industrial clusters and Special Economic Zones toward comprehensive nationwide multimodal ecosystems.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

PIB: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

The battle against inflation is entering a tougher phase: What it means for you

The release of the September inflation data showing a spike to 5.54 percent put the issue in the news. India's retail inflation spiked to 5.54 percent in September, its highest level in nearly two years, driven by surging food, fuel, and transport costs. Rural households have been hit particularly hard, with food inflation crossing 8%. The surge comes amid elevated global crude oil prices, a weakening rupee and continuing uncertainty in West Asia. With inflation nearing the RBI’s upper tolerance limit, questions are growing over whether another interest rate hike could be on the horizon. This explainer examines what’s driving inflation, why food prices are rising and what it could mean for consumers, investors and the broader economy.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** India's retail inflation reached 5.54 percent in September.; Rural food inflation crossed 8 percent.; The spike was driven by food, fuel, and transport costs.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the disproportionate vulnerability of rural households to soaring food prices.; Raises policy dilemmas for the central bank regarding potential interest rate hikes as inflation nears the upper tolerance limit.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India manages monetary policy to maintain price stability while keeping in mind the objective of growth, under the RBI Act of 1934. The Monetary Policy Committee decides the benchmark interest rate required to achieve the inflation target, headed by the RBI Governor. The inflation targeting framework mandates the RBI to maintain retail inflation at 4 percent with a tolerance band of +/- 2 percent.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

The Hindu: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India plans BS-VII emission norms for new cars and SUVs from April 2029

The Centre is planning to introduce Bharat Stage-VII (BS-VII) emission norms starting April 2029 for newly manufactured cars and SUVs. The rollout will be phased, extending up to April 2035 to give manufacturers and testing agencies time to prepare. Small goods delivery vehicles and pick-up vans will follow in 2030, while buses, trucks and heavy-duty vehicles face an April 2031 deadline. The new norms will tighten particle-number testing, lowering the threshold for counted particles from 23 nanometres down to 10 nanometres. Heavy-duty vehicles are expected to face steeper reductions, with proposed emission limits targeting cuts of 20 to 50 percent for various pollutants. For the first time, non-tailpipe emissions such as dust generated by brakes and tyre wear will also come under scrutiny. The standards will apply to vehicles covered by the new manufacturing deadlines and will not automatically scrap older or BS-VI registered vehicles. Unlike the jump from BS-IV to BS-VI, this transition is not expected to require refinery upgrades for cleaner petrol or diesel.

When: April 2029 to April 2035 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Road Transport Ministry · **Prelims:** BS-VII norms rollout for new cars and SUVs is planned from April 2029.; The particle-number testing threshold will be lowered from 23 nanometres to 10 nanometres.; Heavy-duty vehicles like buses and trucks are scheduled to adopt the norms from April 2031.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Targets fine particulate matter down to 10 nanometres, which can travel deep into human lungs and cause severe health risks.; Expands regulatory scope beyond exhaust pipes to include non-tailpipe pollution from tyre wear and braking dust.*

Static — Bharat Stage (BS) emission standards are statutory norms instituted by the government to regulate the output of air pollutants from internal combustion engine equipment and motor vehicles. The Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB), under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, coordinates implementation and monitoring of environmental standards in India. India directly skipped the BS-V norms and transitioned from BS-IV straight to BS-VI nationwide in April 2020, bringing down fuel sulphur content to 10 ppm.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Infrastructure & Energy

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on ndtv.com · also reported by The Economic Times

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

DRDO successfully tests quantum-secured communication to shield sensitive military data

DRDO successfully configured and tested a Quantum Key Distribution platform in the live network of dynamic test ranges at PXE Chandipur. The test was carried out to advance India's capabilities in quantum-secured communications and protect sensitive military data. QKD uses the laws of quantum mechanics to let two parties generate a shared and secret random key for message encryption. The demonstration highlights the use of QKD to fortify real-time critical observations and telemetry during artillery and armoured weapon tests. The system has been designed and developed under the microelectronic devices, computational systems and cyber security cluster of DRDO. Taqbit Labs acted as the production partner for developing the QKD technology. The technology provides unconditional security along with eavesdropping detection capabilities for strategic sectors. Free-space QKD eliminates the need to lay expensive and disruptive optical fibres in challenging terrains and urban environments.

When: 2026-10-14 · **Where:** Proof and Experimental Establishment, Chandipur · **Who:** DRDO and Taqbit Labs · **Prelims:** The QKD platform was tested at Proof and Experimental Establishment, Chandipur.; The technology was designed under the MCC cluster of DRDO.; Taqbit Labs served as the production partner for the QKD platform.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides fundamentally unbreakable encryption to shield sensitive military and strategic data against advanced cyber threats.; Free-space QKD bypasses the need for laying expensive optical fibre cables in difficult and hostile terrains.*

Static — DRDO is the premier agency under the Department of Defence Research and Development in the Ministry of Defence, charged with military's R&D. Quantum Key Distribution secures communication by utilizing properties of photons where any attempt to measure the key disturbs it and alerts the communicating parties. Free-space quantum communication uses optical links through the atmosphere instead of fiber-optic cables, allowing flexible deployment.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Defence

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: read the source · also reported by Economic Times, Madhyamam, India Sentinels

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | REPORT/INDEX | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Cabinet approves Productivity Linked Bonus (PLB) for 78 days to Railway Employees

The Union Cabinet approved a Productivity Linked Bonus of 78 days for eligible railway employees. The total financial implication for this bonus payment is Rs 2009.61 crore. The approval recognizes the excellent performance and operational achievements delivered by railway staff. About 11,40,770 non-gazetted railway employees will benefit from this bonus payout. The maximum amount payable per eligible railway employee is fixed at Rs 17,951 for 78 days.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Central Government approves India’s accession to Southern Indian Ocean Fisheries Agreement (SIOFA)

The Central Government approved India's accession to the Southern Indian Ocean Fisheries Agreement to enhance its role in global fisheries governance. The move follows the Guidelines for High Sea Fisheries issued in December 2025 by the Government of India to expand fishing fleets into international waters. Since 2022, India has been a Cooperating Non-Contracting Party to the SIOFA, which has limited its full participation in decision-making processes.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

NITI Aayog’s Frontier Tech Hub Unveils Data Centre Evaluation Framework to Help States Plan for Sustainable Growth

NITI Aayog's Frontier Tech Hub released the Data Centre Evaluation Framework in New Delhi on 14 October 2026. The initiative aims to help state governments plan for the sustainable growth of data centres across India. The core issue addressed is managing the substantial demands that scaled-up data centres place on electricity, water, land, and connectivity.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

Ministry of Cooperation mandates new Audit Reporting Framework for Multi-State Cooperative Societies to strengthen transparency, accountability and good governance

The Centre announced a new audit reporting framework named the Multi-State Co-operative Societies (Auditor's Report) Order, 2026 (MSCARO 2026). The framework was introduced to make the cooperative sector more transparent, professionally run, accountable, and to protect members' interests. The core issue addressed is the need for uniform and rigorous financial discipline and regulatory oversight to spot irregularities and vulnerabilities early.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

Chairman of the High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC) Justice Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar (Retd.) launches official Portal to Enhance Public Engagement and Scientific Data Gathering

Justice Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar, Chairman of the High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes, launched the official web portal at demography.mha.gov.in in New Delhi. The portal was launched to facilitate public participation, stakeholder submissions, and scientific data collection regarding demographic changes in India. Central ministries, state governments, UT administrations, NGOs, institutions, and individuals can submit data on unnatural demographic changes and abnormal settlement patterns.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Lawyer moves Supreme Court challenging de-notification of Jantar Mantar as protest site

A petition has been filed in the Supreme Court challenging the Delhi police order dated October 11 de-notifying Jantar Mantar as a protest site. The decision follows recommendations by a Union Ministry of Home Affairs committee and a Supreme Court order dated October 9. The petition argues that the de-notification violates fundamental rights under Articles 19(1)(a) and 19(1)(b) of the Constitution.

Bar & Bench: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

CAPF Act doesn’t override Supreme Court’s 2025 verdict, IPS deputation necessary: Centre

The Centre told the Supreme Court that the CAPFs Act, 2026, does not overrule its 2025 judgment on IPS postings. A joint affidavit was filed by the Ministry of Home Affairs, DoPT, and CRPF seeking dismissal of a petition by CAPF officers. The petitioners, led by CRPF Assistant Commandant Bibhor Kumar Singh, had challenged the law as arbitrary and discriminatory.

Hindustan Times: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Odisha Cabinet clears Rs 450-cr skill development scheme 'Dakshyata Vikas Yojana'

The Odisha state cabinet approved the flagship skill development scheme named Dakshyata Vikas Yojana with an outlay of Rs 450 crore. The scheme was approved during a cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi. Chief secretary Anu Garg stated that the two-year initiative aims to strengthen employability and prepare youth for emerging domestic and global opportunities.

newindianexpress.com: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY QUICK READ

India to launch National Electricity Data Sharing Framework in October

The government is set to launch the National Electricity Data Sharing Framework to provide unified power sector data. The framework covers generation, transmission, distribution, grid operations, and power markets. It aims to help sector players and startups make informed decisions and business plans. Power Secretary Pankaj Agarwal announced the launch during a brainstorming conclave organised by CEA and FICCI.

BusinessLine: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

India seeks an Indo-Pacific where all countries make their own choices, protect their interests & pursue development in peace: Raksha Mantri at 1st ASEAN-India Defence Think Tank Forum

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh stated that India seeks an Indo-Pacific where all nations make independent choices, protect interests, and pursue peaceful development. He addressed the maiden ASEAN-India Defence Think Tank Forum held at the Manohar Parrikar Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses in New Delhi. He highlighted that India and ASEAN share interests in peace, stability, and an open, inclusive, and multipolar Indo-Pacific region.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

As A Follow-Up to The Departmental Summit on Water 2026, Department Of Drinking Water and Sanitation Organised Virtual Conference On Convergence Of JJM 2.0 With VB-G RAM G For Source Sustainability And Gram Panchayat-Led Water Governance

The Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation organised a virtual conference to discuss the convergence of Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 with VB-G RAM G for source sustainability and local water governance.

PIB: source

HEALTH QUICK READ

NCISM Chairperson launches CCRAS SPARK 5.0 and CCRAS Ayurshodh 2026 to strengthen Ayurveda research and innovation

The NCISM Chairperson launched CCRAS SPARK 5.0 and CCRAS Ayurshodh 2026 to strengthen Ayurveda research and innovation. The initiatives aim to foster research aptitude, analytical thinking, and early research careers among undergraduate students. CCRAS SPARK 5.0 offers 300 studentships of rupees fifty thousand each for eligible BAMS students. Eligible candidates for SPARK 5.0 include third, fourth, or professional year BAMS students in recognized colleges.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

KIIFB reorganisation: Cabinet approves expert committee report

The Kerala state cabinet approved the expert committee report on the reorganisation of the Kerala Infrastructure Investment Fund Board on Wednesday. The five-member panel was headed by former Union home secretary Sudha Pillai and submitted its recommendations for comprehensive restructuring. The cabinet also decided to table the submitted report in the state assembly on Thursday.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

ECONOMY SCHEME ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Premature redemption under Sovereign Gold Bond (SGB) Scheme - Redemption Price for premature redemption of SGB 2019-20 Series V due on October 15, 2026

The Reserve Bank of India issued a press release detailing the upcoming premature redemption date and pricing methodology for the specific SGB series. The Reserve Bank of India has outlined the schedule and pricing mechanism for the premature redemption of Sovereign Gold Bond 2019-20 Series V due on October 15, 2026.

RBI: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY SCHEME QUICK READ

Advanced Chemicals, Petrochemicals and Material Technologies Included under Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Scheme

The government included Advanced Chemicals, Petrochemicals and Material Technologies as an additional technology area eligible for funding under the Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Scheme. This decision is effective from October 8, 2026, following a proposal by the Department of Chemicals and Petrochemicals under the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | DAY/OBSERVANCE | QUICK READ

Quality Infrastructure, Clean Energy and Consumer Safety Take Centre Stage at the National Celebration of World Standards Day 2026

Bureau of Indian Standards unveiled the BIS Silver Refinery Scheme, new standards on emerging technologies, and a sustainable manufacturing roadmap. The announcements were made during the national celebration of World Standards Day 2026 hosted in New Delhi. The event focused on this year's theme of a shared vision for a better world aligned with SDG 7 on clean and affordable energy.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

SC/ST voices condemn Karnataka Hight Court verdict striking down enhanced reservation

The Karnataka High Court delivered a verdict striking down the enhanced reservation quotas for SC and ST communities. Various Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe representatives in Karnataka strongly condemned the High Court verdict striking down the state's enhanced reservation policy. Various individuals and organisations representing Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes communities in the State expressed deep disappointment with the Karnataka High Court verdict that struck down the enhanced reservation

The Hindu: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

TDB signs agreement with ideaForge for Rs. 151 crore RDI support to develop YETI heavy-lift autonomous aerial logistics vehicle

The Technology Development Board signed an agreement with ideaForge Technology Limited to provide financial support of Rs. 151 crore for developing the YETI aerial vehicle. The financial backing is provided through debt financing under the government's Research Development and Innovation Fund. The total project cost is estimated at Rs. 302 crore, aiming to advance the autonomous logistics vehicle from Technology Readiness Level-4 to Level-9.

PIB: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

TRISHNA Satellite Mission 2027: ISRO-France Mission, Objectives and Features

ISRO and France will launch the TRISHNA satellite mission in 2027 to monitor water stress, crop health, and urban heat. The mission is designed to address critical water and food security challenges driven by human-induced climate change and water management needs. The satellite will deliver high spatial and temporal resolution monitoring of Earth surface temperature, emissivity, and radiation variables.

theprint.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Top Legal Developments [5-11 October]: Delhi Metro shutdown Jantar Mantar protest, Bangalore Water Supply Triple Test judgment, JIO trademark infringement rogue websites and other Key verdicts and Policy Updates

It covers weekly legal highlights including the Delhi Metro shutdown, Jantar Mantar protest, and the Bangalore Water Supply Triple Test judgment. A compilation of key legal developments, verdicts, and policy updates occurring between 5 and 11 October.

SCC Online: source

ECONOMY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

OMC signs MoU with AMD to explore critical minerals in Odisha

Odisha Mining Corporation Ltd. signed an MoU with the Atomic Minerals Directorate for Exploration and Research to explore critical minerals in Odisha. The agreement aims to strengthen domestic critical mineral supplies in line with the National Critical Mineral Mission. Both entities will collaborate on research, exchange technical information, share expertise, and explore critical minerals in OMC lease areas and across Odisha.

psuwatch.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | QUICK READ

Manipur launches clouded leopard, vulture conservation projects on 72nd Wildlife Week

Manipur launched the Manipur Clouded Leopard Conservation Project and the Vulture Conservation Project during the 72nd Wildlife Week celebration in Imphal. The initiatives aim to protect endangered species, restore populations, and curb illegal wildlife trafficking through enhanced inter-agency coordination. Clouded leopards inhabit the hill areas of Manipur, while wild vulture populations have declined significantly with only four or five currently conserved at the Manipur Zoological Garden.

msn.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | APPOINTMENT | QUICK READ

Sh. Cheedhara Srinivas appointed Secy of Viksit Bharat Abhiyan

Sh. Cheedhara Srinivas has been officially appointed as the Secretary of Viksit Bharat Abhiyan by its Authority. He will develop strategic frameworks, oversee implementation, and strengthen multi-sector coordination for the initiative. His priorities include policy formulation, inter-institutional coordination, and ensuring benefits reach the last person in society. He will also promote partnerships with industry leaders, academic institutions, and social organizations, with a focus on youth and digital empowerment.

theprint.in: source

ECONOMY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Monetary Policy Outlook: Nomura Projects 25 bps RBI Rate Hike in December Amid Rising Core Inflation

The forecast was reported as part of the latest monetary policy outlook amid shifting macroeconomic indicators. Nomura has projected a 25 basis points rate hike by the Reserve Bank of India in December due to rising core inflation.

PSU India: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 UPSC Editorial Analysis: India’s Growth vs. Jobs Debate

India is the fastest-growing major economy with a GDP expansion of 6.5% to 7.5% per year, yet it faces the critical challenge of job-deficient growth. The official Periodic Labour Force Survey reports a low unemployment rate of 3.1% to 3.2% using the Usual Status measure, which counts anyone working for just 30 days a year as employed. Youth make up 83% of India's total unemployed population, with college graduates aged 15-29 facing unemployment rates between 25% and 30%.

Insights on India

GS2 Without police reform, constitutional freedoms are stillborn

Recent protests in New Delhi, Jharkhand, and Madhya Pradesh faced heavy police crackdowns, highlighting how easily police forces become repressive arms of the political executive. Prohibitory orders and arbitrary denials of permission routinely turn peaceful gatherings into unlawful assemblies, violating constitutional rights to assemble peaceably. The core problem is structural as police postings, promotions, and careers depend entirely on the political executive, creating incentives to serve ruling parties.

Deccan Herald

GS2 The real SIR failure may lie in newsrooms, not only in the Election Commission

The article examines why democracies fail to grapple with real issues, focusing on the role of information and media. Information availability in democracies is high, but its quality depends heavily on rigorous research and reliable sources. Social media cacophony, smartphone citizen journalism, and clickbait headlines by traditional media make finding real facts difficult. Social media algorithms and confirmation bias trap voters in echo chambers, making them susceptible to shrillness over reality.

ThePrint

GS3 The Nobel prize winners for 2026 rebuilt stabilization policy—Here's why that matters

The editorial discusses the contributions of Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford, the 2026 Nobel prize winners in economics, who rebuilt stabilization policy by providing a rigorous basis for evaluating monetary and fiscal measures. Their approach now informs central banks across the world. Here’s the academic trail they pursued.

Mint

GS2 The long wait: What 24 Supreme Court references reveal about judicial delay

A study of 24 Supreme Court references to seven or more judges between January 2000 and September 2026 shows extreme judicial delay, with cases waiting for decades. A Supreme Court bench cannot overrule a decision by a bench of the same size or bigger, requiring a reference to a larger bench when doubts arise. Under the master of the roster convention, only the Chief Justice can form benches and fix hearing dates, with no legal rule mandating timeframes for references.

Bar & Bench

GS2 GS3 Margin caps on cancer drugs, could there be more on the anvil?

The Central Government approved a cap on trade margins of non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs at 30% of the Maximum Retail Price. The measure responds to high medicine prices, excessive mark-ups, and concerns raised by the Supreme Court regarding patient out-of-pocket expenditure. NPPA data analysis indicates that non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs carry an average trade mark-up of about 170%, reaching up to 700% in certain cases. The new measure is expected to reduce medicine prices by up to 70% and help cancer patients save approximately Rs. 2,500 crore annually.

BusinessLine

GS3 TCA Anant: Is India in a vibecession? Household sentiment lags economic performance

Persistent gaps between macroeconomic performance and household sentiment have sparked debates on whether India is facing a vibecession. The article discusses the gap between strong economic data and lagging public sentiment, suggesting a need to examine RBI sentiment trackers. Persistent gaps between economic data and public perceptions should make us examine the surveys designed to measure the popular mood. Here's a look at RBI's sentiment trackers and what could be done to improve them.

Mint

GS3 Economics Nobel — key takeaways for India

It is in the news following the announcement of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economics. The editorial discusses the implications of the 2026 Economics Nobel awarded to Robert Hall and Michael Woodford, emphasizing the role of expectations and data quality for India. Robert Hall and Michael Woodford showed that economic policy works through what people expect. In India, that makes the quality of official data a policy question

BusinessLine

GS3 NASA's Perseverance rover sets a Mars driving record

NASA's Perseverance rover has surpassed the distance record of Opportunity, ticking past a total driving distance of 28.1 miles on Mars. The milestone was announced by NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory after confirming the rover's new total odometer reading in Jezero Crater. Perseverance delayed crossing this milestone by two months because it paused to study intriguing, light-coloured ancient rocks in Lac de Charmes. Project scientist Katie Stack Morgan noted that science remains the primary reason for the rover's presence, prioritizing rock analysis over speed.

Deccan Herald

GS2 Why Bangladesh cannot afford to trade India for China

Bangladesh has sought continued duty-free access for its exports to India after graduating from the Least Developed Country category. Bangladesh signed a $335.78 million loan agreement with China to modernise Mongla Port, which is located 80 kilometres from the Indian border. These simultaneous developments on 12 October 2026 highlight contradictions in Bangladesh's economic and strategic policies. While seeking Indian trade concessions, Dhaka is simultaneously turning towards China for strategically sensitive infrastructure projects.

ThePrint

GS3 As inflation inches upwards, can rate hike be far behind?

Retail inflation rose to 5.54 per cent in September from 4.83 per cent in August, driven largely by food prices. Food inflation surged to 7.74 per cent in September, led by items like onions, ginger, garlic, and lemon, alongside a 5.8 per cent jump in the FAO food price index. Non-food categories and core inflation are also moving upwards to 4.3 per cent, indicating a broad-based pass-through of higher costs.

msn.com

GS3 Rupee stopgap: RBI's new props have boosted its external value but this only spells momentary relief

The RBI introduced new props and emergency measures to support the falling Indian rupee. The editorial discusses the RBI's emergency measures to support the rupee's external value, arguing that they offer only momentary relief. The central bank's emergency measures to support India's currency hint of panic. They could also make risk-hedging dearer. For real relief from exchange rate weakness, the country's macro dynamics will need to move in the rupee's favour.

Mint

GS3 BRICS must rejig CBAM

The text is an opinion piece from BusinessLine discussing the stance of BRICS on global carbon border taxes. An opinion piece arguing that BRICS nations should reform and engage with the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism rather than completely rejecting it. Why the mechanism should not be rejected fully

BusinessLine

GS3 Mint Quick Edit | IMF outlook: India's economy has held up impressively

The latest set of International Monetary Fund forecasts was released, highlighting India's robust economic performance. The International Monetary Fund has revised India's economic growth forecast upward to 7 percent for the current fiscal year and the next. While this pace is reassuring, we must relentlessly pursue reforms aimed at sharpening an export edge.

Mint

GS3 GST 3.0 bets on ease of process

The 57th GST Council meeting decisions aim for a simpler, more predictable taxation system focusing on process ease and compliance. The reforms follow last year's rate structure rationalisation and reflect a guiding principle of trust in taxpayers instead of suspicion. Proposed changes include removing arrest powers and raising the prosecution threshold from Rs 1 crore to Rs 5 crore. The Council decided to stop issuing show-cause notices for tax amounts below Rs 10,000.

Deccan Herald

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Explained: Keralam bill proposes first-of-its-kind framework to regulate elderly care The state introduced the bill to establish the first formal regulatory mechanism for elderly care homes in the region. Kerala has proposed a pioneering legislative framework aimed at regulating elderly care institutions to ensure safety and quality standards.
Indian Express

Preventive Detention – Significance & Concerns Recent police detentions of protesters to prevent demonstrations have raised concerns about balancing public order with democratic freedoms and personal liberty. Preventive detention involves detaining a person without a criminal trial to prevent potential offences or activities prejudicial to public order and national security.
ForumIAS

Preventive detention explained: Know your constitutional rights Detentions during the October 10 protests brought renewed attention to preventive detention, constitutional protections, and state power limits. This explainer breaks down the legal framework governing preventive detention, Section 163 of the BNSS, and constitutional safeguards available in India. When can authorities legally detain someone without trial?
The Hindu

Pakistan's 22% water crunch: A domestic crisis or the fallout of India's treaty freeze? Reports highlighted a 22 percent water deficit in Pakistan alongside scrutiny of the Indus Waters Treaty framework. Pakistan faces a reported 22 percent water crunch, raising concerns about internal management and regional water-sharing dynamics.
Firstpost

Knowledge Nugget | 57th GST Council meeting: What are the key decisions? The 57th GST Council meeting took place to address critical taxation updates and structural reforms. This explainer details the key decisions, deliberations, and tax adjustments made during the 57th meeting of the GST Council.
Indian Express

Elder Abuse, Property Grab Can Land You In Jail Under Kerala's Senior Citizens Bill The Bill is in the news following legislative and administrative focus on protecting the rights and safety of elderly residents in Kerala. Kerala has proposed a new Senior Citizens Bill aimed at penalizing elder abuse and property grabbing with jail time.
News18

Why is Spain facing a housing crisis? The escalating housing protests, government policy debates, and political stakes surrounding affordability have put the crisis in global headlines. Spain is grappling with a severe housing crisis driven by soaring costs, tourism pressures, and investment funds, straining the government. Why is Spain struggling to provide affordable housing?
The Hindu

India's inflation hits 5.54%: Onion prices up 108%, food inflation 7.74% | 10 numbers explained The release of the latest economic data showing retail inflation hitting 5.54 percent put it in the news. India's retail inflation rose to 5.54 percent, propelled by a 7.74 percent food inflation rate and a 108 percent surge in onion prices.
Economic Times

Decoding India's inflation: Onions, silver key drivers; more storage capacity will make RBI's task easier India's Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation rose to 5.54 percent in September 2026 from 4.83 percent in August, approaching the RBI's upper tolerance limit of 6 percent. The spike was driven by specific categories rather than broad economic overheating, with onions, silver, and lorry goods transportation being the key drivers.
theprint.in

'Like a conversation with a fellow mathematician over coffee': How AI is reshaping maths research, careers Growing integration of AI tools in advanced scientific research and academic discussions. An explainer on how artificial intelligence is transforming mathematical research, changing workflows, and altering career paths for mathematicians.
Indian Express

Can plastic-to-fuel technology help address India's plastic waste challenge? It is in the news due to rising concerns over plastic pollution and discussions on sustainable waste management technologies. This explainer examines whether plastic-to-fuel technology can effectively address India's growing plastic waste challenge.
Indian Express

As AI solves complex maths problems, researchers ask: What makes a proof valuable? AI systems are increasingly solving complex mathematics problems and generating formal proofs, triggering discussions among researchers. An explainer on how AI advancements in solving complex math problems are forcing researchers to reevaluate the core value and nature of mathematical proofs.
Indian Express

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- In meeting with Rubio, Jaishankar raises India's concerns about sanctions Act (International Relations) The Hindu
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurates five development projects worth Rs. 3,350 crore in Ladakh (Governance & Policy) Hindustan Times

- Supreme Court Must Revisit Verdict Upholding SIR: Justice Abhay Oka (Polity & Constitution) Live Law
- Release of 121st Issue of Sarvekshana, Journal of Official Statistics (Governance & Policy) PIB
- Tribal affairs ministry, Karmayogi Bharat join hands to train 1.54 lakh volunteers under iGOT framework (Governance & Policy) Hindustan Times
- India and Brunei Darussalam Review Bilateral Trade and Economic Cooperation at Third Joint Trade Committee Meeting (International Relations) PIB
- Owaisi Moves SC Against Election Commission's SIR Exercise (Polity & Constitution) Deccan Chronicle
- India's ultra-short-term borrowing costs spike; premium over policy rate hits 4-year high (Economy) Economic Times
- India's first Red List Assessment of Ecosystems (RLE) Project (Environment & Ecology) The Hindu
- India Strengthens Science and Technology Partnerships with Global South through Inaugural Ministry of External Affairs–CSIR Tech Familiarization Programme (Science & Technology) PIB
- Government Constitutes Committee to Examine Issues Relating to Sugarcane Farmers and the Sugar Sector (Agriculture & Allied) PIB
- 'Deeply unfortunate': Sheikh Hasina on Bangladesh skipping India-hosted BRICS summit (International Relations) The Hindu
- Dudhwa Tiger Reserve to conduct survey to assess Suheli River's century-long changes (Environment & Ecology) ThePrint
- Shipbuilding Project Credit Risk Insurance Policy (SbPCP) and Business Credit Shield Policy–Shipbuilders (BCSPS) (Economy) ForumIAS
- Pralhad Joshi Launches Silver Refinery Certification Scheme (Economy) Rediff MoneyWiz
- Nagaland launches GHH scheme, identifies 1.21 lakh beneficiaries in first phase (Governance & Policy) ThePrint
- Delhi High Court seeks FSSAI stand on PIL against non-dairy, analogous 'paneer' (Governance & Policy) Bar & Bench
- Notification issued for 2,721 teacher posts through DSC-2026 (Education) NDTV
- Assembly ban imposed in Upper Siang, protesters detained under UAPA (Internal Security) Mongabay India
- Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman to embark on an official visit to Bangkok, Thailand, from 14th to 18th October 2026 (International Relations) PIB
- DoT and ITU organise AI for Good Build-a-thon 5.0 at India Mobile Congress 2026 (Science & Technology) PIB
- INDIAN NAVY TO HAND OVER COMMAND OF COMBINED TASK FORCE 154 (Defence) PIB
- World Bank Group mobilises $36 billion in India in four years, $9.6 billion for MSMEs (Economy) BusinessLine
- AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE GOVERNMENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF INDIA AND THE GOVERNMENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF UZBEKISTAN ON COOPERATION IN THE (International Relations) Ministry of External Affairs
- Exercise Cambrian Patrol 2026 (CP26) (Defence) Insights on India
- Tripura Plans to Reopen Kailashahar Airport After 35 Years Under the UDAN Scheme (Infrastructure & Energy) IndianEagle
- Retail inflation surge puts RBI's growth priorities to test (Economy) Policy Circle
- India must seek UNESCO tag for ports to mark oceanic journeys of girmitiyas: Fiji envoy (History, Art & Culture) ThePrint
- Keralam braces for northeast monsoon after 28% southwest monsoon deficit (Disaster Management) The Hindu
- CERVAVAC Becomes India's 1st WHO-Prequalified Indigenous HPV Vaccine (Health) Drishti IAS
- GM Crops and India's Agricultural Future (Agriculture & Allied) Drishti IAS
- Rajnath Singh calls for deeper India-ASEAN defence cooperation, joint development of military technologies (International Relations) The Hindu
- India needs Rs. 15 lakh cr investment to add 91 GW nuclear capacity by 2047: CEA chairman (Infrastructure & Energy) BusinessLine
- "Environmental degradation is not merely a failure of regulatory compliance but a reflection of deeper ethical failures in the relationship between economic activity and society." Elucidate. (Ethics & Integrity) Insights on India
- UP CEO Admits ECI Auto-generated 85,000+ Voter Deletion Forms Without a Reason, Confirms Mass Deletion Attempts Against Muslims (Polity & Constitution) The Reporters' Collective
- Army gets largest batch of indigenous loitering munitions (Defence) Economic Times
- What geographical factors make the Indian subcontinent particularly vulnerable to heatwaves? Illustrate the spatial variations in their occurrence and intensity. (Geography) Insights on India
- The New Logic of Space Warfare (Science & Technology) Observer Research Foundation
- IMF Lifts India's FY27 Outlook to 7% as Domestic Demand Holds Firm (Economy) Moneylife
- US secretary of state Rubio to travel to India next week; energy, strategic partnership and investment in focus (International Relations) Times of India
- Oil prices today: Brent crude hits $106.60 after Saudi Aramco attack, ship strikes near Hormuz (Economy) Hindustan Times
- RBI Tightens Bank Liquidity Requirements (Economy) Bankersadda

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 18 must-know, 24 Prelims facts, 42 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (10), Economy (9), Governance & Policy (8), International Relations (4), Science & Technology (4), Environment & Ecology (3), Social Justice & Welfare (2), Infrastructure & Energy (1), Health (1). **Nothing today in —** Education, Agriculture & Allied, Internal Security, Defence, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 3 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 2

Full text — 42 of 69 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — PIB 15, Mint 5, BusinessLine 5, The Hindu 5, Indian Express 5, Economic Times 4, theprint.in 3, Deccan Herald 3, timesofindia.indiatimes.com 2, Hindustan Times 2, Bar & Bench 2, msn.com 2, ThePrint 2, Careers360 1

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